

## **STANDING ORDER NO. Ops. - 55**

**(Previous Standing Order No. 337/2010)**

### **PUBLIC AS 'EYES AND EARS' OF THE POLICE**

Action against terrorists in particular and against criminals in general, is undoubtedly the first and foremost responsibility of the police. All possible steps need to be taken to ensure that such elements do not succeed in their nefarious designs. If an incident does take place, it is an equally onerous responsibility to ensure that the accused are apprehended at the earliest. Such action by itself is a major deterrent. Development of criminal intelligence is one of the basic tools available with the police to prevent commission of offences or to detect those which have been committed. Criminal intelligence can be collected by various means including development of sources, eliciting information from criminals and informers, interrogation of criminals/other accused, keeping track on jail releases, studying modus operandi, surveillance, patrolling etc. etc. These measures are being taken by the police from time to time.

There is, however, one major source of criminal/terrorist related information/intelligence which is not being addressed in an institutionalized manner by the police. This includes individuals such as rehri/patriwalas/vendors, chokidars/security guards, car-parking attendants, three-wheelers/TSR drivers parked in markets/colonies, porters, etc. These individuals should be briefed and their cooperation sought regarding information about movement of criminals/terrorists. They should be treated as the 'eyes and ears' of the police. Such individuals sitting on side-walks/pavements, roads, railway platforms etc. see people moving up and down throughout the day. Over a period of time, they are able to gather a lot of information which never reaches the operational levels of the police or reaches in a limited manner. They get to hear about individuals indulging in crimes and their modus operandi. They are in a good position to see suspicious activities and movements of individuals particularly if an individual leaves behind a bag or any unidentified object in a suspicious manner. Beat Constables/Division Officers should be in contact with such individuals on a day-to-day basis. At least one fortnightly meeting must be organized with rehri/patriwalas, chokidars, security guards/chokidars, three-wheelers/TSR drivers, taxi stands, parking lot attendants (authorized/unauthorized), porters etc. by the Beat Constables/Division Officers. The SHO must hold a meeting with such individuals of each area atleast once a month. The ACP should also hold such meetings in each area once in 2 months and the DCP should also hold such meetings at least once in three months. This aside, a detailed record should be maintained regarding each of the meetings held, number of persons from each occupation who attended etc. etc. The Beat Constable should have the names and categories of each of such individuals operating in his area clearly recorded in his beat book. If they have mobile phones, these should be available in the beat book. The Beat Constable/Division Officer must encourage such



elements to contact them even if the information is sketchy or not very reliable. When fortnightly meetings are held at the Beat/Division level or monthly meeting at the SHO, names of those who attended and the category to which they belong should be recorded so that the meetings become meaningful. Video recordings of such meetings, at least, that taken by the SHO, should also be made for scrutiny by superior officers.

Besides the above mentioned individuals, there are several other categories of citizens who can be motivated to act as “eyes and ears” of the police such as:

1. Residents of colonies through the residents welfare associations.
2. Traders through the market associations.
3. Nagrik Surkksha Samitis.
4. Persons working at STD/ISD booths.
5. Cyber cafes.
6. Washermen, barbers, cobblers, plumbers, key lock repairers, etc.
7. Students.
8. Petrol pump workers.
9. Doctors’ clinic and even doctors in slum/small areas.
10. Domestic help providers/domestic help.
11. TV/fridge/computer mechanics.
12. Mother-dairy booth operators.
13. Security and other staff of hotels/guest houses/eating houses particularly Dhabas. Focus should be on the dhabas at borders where normally truck drivers take rest, eat food and repair their vehicles.
14. Staff of cinema halls, places of entertainments, auditoriums.
15. Security guards deployed in vital installations, government/private office buildings.
16. Property dealers/Kabaries.
17. Bank guards.
18. Mobile phone and card dealers.
19. Bus drivers/conductors.

This list is illustrative and not exhaustive and could include any other member of the community.

Terrorism and crime prevention are major priority areas for us and it is imperative that all possible stakeholders are associated in our attempts to keep surveillance over activities of a suspicious nature. Unless we motivate various sections of the community, as above mentioned, in a positive manner, we will not be able to provide quality policing and safety/security to the citizens of the capital.

A special helpline number 1090 has been started which should be conveyed to each and every stake holder above mentioned. They should be motivated to give information directly to the local police officers or to the helpline. They may be assured that details of the callers to the helpline would be kept confidential. If they do not want to give their names, addresses,

etc. they would not be compelled to do so. Advertisements should also be taken out in this regard in the newspapers by the PRO.

The District DCsP, ACsP/Sub Divisions and SHO must make concerted efforts to develop the 'eyes and ears' of the Delhi Police. Their success in their assignments to a great extent will be measured by their success in implementing the scheme. Action taken should be reflected in the fortnightly law and order meeting by the Crime Branch based on statistics and information provided to them by the districts.

DCP/PCR shall ensure that helpline 1090 is manned 24x7 and all messages recorded. Information received should be passed on by telephone to the concerned SHO/DCP. A confidential record be maintained. The caller has the option to disclose his identity or not. The helpline operator should try to make the caller feel as comfortable as possible and re-ensure him about the confidentiality of his identity. On the other hand, if the caller wants to disclose his identity contact address/telephone number then it should be recorded. The I/C Command Room and the DCP/PCR shall be responsible to ensure proper functioning of the helpline/sanction of rewards in appropriate cases. The District/Unit DCsP should also ensure that informants are directly rewarded for any useful information provided if they have given their names/contact address/numbers and are willing to accept rewards.

Much of the success Israel has experienced in thwarting terrorist bombings is being attributed to public awareness. The majority of explosive devices placed in public sites, such as bus stands, super markets or shopping centres have been discovered by community members who were able to alert the police before the bombs went off. We need to emulate this success. The performance of district officers, particularly of the SHOs and the police station staff, would be measured on how successful they are in mobilizing public support and creating not only awareness amongst the stake holders but also the desire to step forward and contribute. For this, the police station staff would themselves have to raise their performance bar and create confidence amongst all sections of the community.

#### **SUPERCESSION CLAUSE**

This will supersede Standing Order No. 337/2008 issued vide No. 3096-195/C&T/(AC-VI)/PHQ dated 18.01.2008 and corrigendum issued vide No. 3499-3598/C&T (AC-VI)/PHQ dated 21.01.2008.

  
(Yudhbir Singh Dadwal)  
Commissioner of Police  
Delhi

O.B. No. 75 /RB/PHQ dated 25/10/2010

No. 12051-12300 /Record Branch/PHQ dated, Delhi the, 25/10/2010.